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Introduction

DHL Finance Team invites proposals from qualified suppliers for a Conversational AI solution that can support collections and account-support use cases through voice-based interactions, with the ability to operate as either an on-premises deployment or a SaaS/off-premise service. The proposed solution must be capable of handling high-volume **outbound reminders** and **limited inbound support calls**, integrate with SAP where feasible, support multilingual and natural conversations, provide performance benchmarks and guardrails, and meet enterprise requirements for privacy, deletion, auditability, and operational resilience. The solution is required for **duty and freight** invoices of both **import and export types**.

Scope Width:

1st Priority - Outbound Calls to Customers

1. Payment Reminders, Follow-ups, Negotiations and Guidance
2. Credit Limit Breach Alerts for PoC
3. Addressing customer queries, guidance and connect with human agents (if necessary)

2nd Priority - Inbound Calls from Customers

1. Invoice Copy & Paperwork
2. Disputes: Weight/Pricing/DTP
3. Email ID Updates
4. First Time Resolution

Monthly Outbound & Inbound Call Volume

Freight Invoices	Duty Invoices	Alerts
~100K calls of 90-120 seconds each (subjected to expand once PoC* is established)		

*Proof of Concept

Purpose Statement (WHY):

The business need is to improve collections effectiveness, reduce manual follow-up effort, and accelerate payment closure through timely, conversational outreach that can handle objections, negotiate payment commitments, and capture outcomes in a structured way. While email can support reminders, DHL requires a voice-first capability because payment conversations often need immediate objection handling, commitment capture, and escalation decisions that are difficult to achieve through asynchronous email alone.

Requirement:

We seek to modernize the payment collections and account-support interactions through a Conversational AI solution that can manage high-volume customer outreach, while remaining compliant, scalable, and operationally efficient. The solution must support both outbound payment reminders and inbound account-support queries, integrate where feasible with DHL's SAP environment, and provide a natural, multilingual customer experience with measurable control over latency, ASR, accuracy, concurrency, and governance.

- The majority of calls will be outbound and to B2B customers for sending first-time payment reminders, follow-ups on previous calls, and account related alerts
- We use SAP as our CRM software which is a global enterprise grade on-premises solution. If you have deployed a likewise solution with any client with SAP - kindly share the case study with us to brainstorm and discuss further. If not deployed with SAP, then how will we provide you data that can be used to make calls and follow-up with customers

- The agent should be capable to converse in primary regional languages of India alongwith English. (e.g. Hinglish)
- We prefer the call recordings, transcripts, and related metadata directly save on DHL owned servers, or transfer via SFTP given the condition that it should be deleted from vendor servers after defined timeline
- The vendor should adopt an agile delivery model, with weekly sprints covering discovery, solution design, PoC, integration, UAT, and deployment

Expected Competencies (inter-alia but not limited to):

Aspect	Explanatory Notes
Conversational tone & personalization	The AI agent must converse in a natural, human-like tone, avoiding rigid or transcriptive scripts. It should adapt to context, customer history, and prior interaction outcomes.
Payment-recovery negotiation & multilingual support	The agent must be trained in payment-recovery negotiations, including deferring payments, proposing payment plans (optional), handling objections, and escalating to human agents where required. It should dynamically switch languages and support key regional languages in a polite-cum-assertive manner, maintaining DHL-compliant policies
Performance & scalability KPIs	The vendor must define and commit to benchmarks for: - Latency (end-to-end response time) - ASR accuracy per language and region - Concurrent call capacity (at peak, and sustained) - RAG or context-aware retrieval precision for account-related queries - Guardrails (e.g., PCI-compliant handling of payment details, PII redaction, escalation rules, and tone-compliance)
Inbound call support	The solution should support inbound calls for: - Invoice and document retrieval. - Password reset guide. - Weight-dispute and billing-error escalations with clear categorization and routing logic.
Data handling & security	All conversations and integrated data must comply with international and regional regulations, including but not limited to: GDPR, SOC frameworks, HIPAA (where applicable), EU AI Act, NIST CSF, DORA, India’s DPDP Act, and the Information Technology Act.

Show me how your agent act in following Scenario

You have to call a customer to collect outstanding invoices. The company is called “Mind Your Business Inc.” Your contact person is Mr. Anthony Gressive or Mrs. Anna Gressive and you will call using his or her direct telephone number.

The following invoices are outstanding:

Account Number	Invoice Number	Outstanding Balance	Overdue Days	Invoice Date	Telephone
DHL001	DHL123456	₹13,600	60	1-Jan-26	9813640644
DHL001	DHL654321	₹34,650	45	1-Feb-26	9813640644
DHL001	DHL332241	₹9,670	30	1-Mar-26	9813640644

The Customer has a problem with 1 waybill on invoice DHL123456. According to the Customer, there was a difference between the price on their price list and the actual invoiced price.

You know that this has been resolved, and a credit note has been issued. On invoice DHL654321, an issue was recorded for 2 shipments (both shipments were delayed). This has also been resolved, and a credit note has been issued, quite some time ago. The week after the credit note was issued you called the Customer, and they actually confirmed that they received the credit note. At this moment there are no further issues recorded on any of these invoices. Although all issues have been resolved, according to your data no payment has yet been received.

Tell your agent to call the customer and collect the payment:

1. Find out why the payment has not yet been made
2. Get a payment promise date from the Customer
3. Provide different options of payment – DHL MyBill Portal, Virtual Account Number

Remember common rules and what has been discussed so far about:

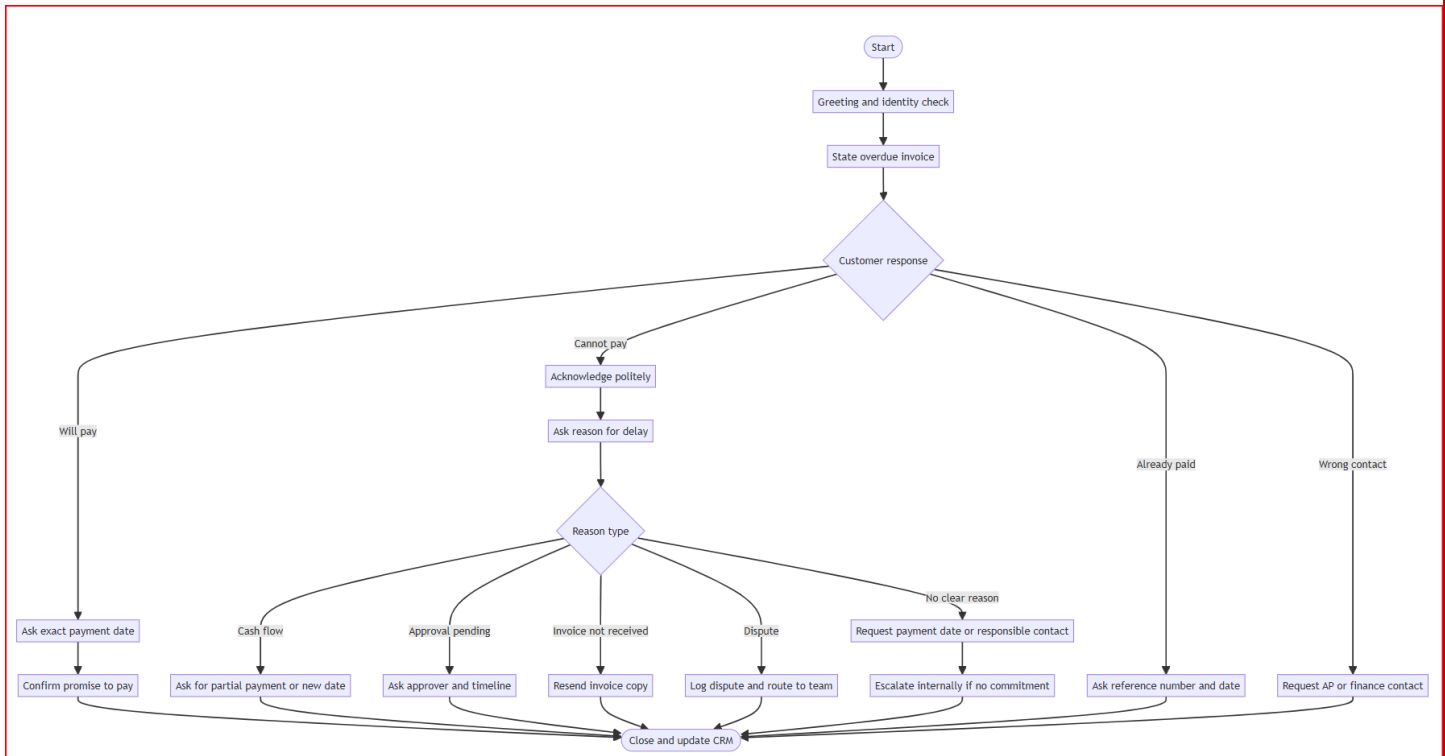
1. Staying in control of yourself and the conversation
2. Start call with greetings and Listen actively
3. Ask needful and right questions, and do negotiations
4. Use effective language and be assertive in tone
5. Show Empathy
6. Use the right tactics
7. Don't abuse

There could be multiple scenarios, but the agent should be capable of capturing the sentiment of customer and judge if they are making payment delay tactics or actually the customer don't have money to pay.

For instalments, disputes or refund related queries take the notes and connect the call if customer insist to connect with human agent. Following are the contact details of human agent:

Name	Designation	Phone
Ms Sanorita	Collections Executive	09416340644

While on call with customer, following scenarios can be created:



Template: First-time reminder (unpaid, due date passed)

Hello, am I speaking with [Customer Name/AP Team] from [Company Name]?

If customer say no or connected to wrong person:

Could you please connect me to the person handling accounts payable or payments for your company?

If customer say concern person is on leave:

I would appreciate if you can connect me with alternate person in absence of [Mangesh] because I see there are several outstanding invoices in your DHL account due to which the account's credit worthiness may get impacted.

If customer reply Yes or connected with correct person:

Good afternoon/morning/evening, my name is Yogesh and calling from DHL Express India. This is regarding your credit account with DHL with total outstanding of [₹__]

We have an unpaid invoice [Invoice No.] dated [Date] for [₹Amount], which was due on [Due Date]. The payment is currently overdue. Could you please pay the invoice.

If customer confirms paying soon:

Thank you. Could you please share the expected date of payment?

If date is vague or more than 2 day:

Sorry, it seems your provided date is too far. I request you to provide a specific date within 2 business days?

If customer claims already paid:

Understood. Could you please email the payment proof to yogesh.jhamb@dhl.com with transaction reference number and date? I'll verify with our system and revert within 24 hours.

Post-call:

Raise internal query and schedule follow-up if mismatch is found.

If customer denies payment:

Acknowledge politely. I understand. Thank you for sharing that with me.

Explore reason and try level best to collect payment before 25th of every month:

May I know the reason for the delay so that I can note it correctly?

Possible customer reasons:**A. Cash flow issue**

- Agent: Understood. I request you to make any partial payment as of now, or a confirmed date for full payment.
 - **If customer gives a date**
 - Thank you. I will note that payment will be made by [Date]. Please ensure the payment is released by then.
 - **If customer gives no date**
 - I request you to share at least an expected timeline, so we can update our records and avoid putting account on stop which may stop you from creating shipments

B. Internal approval pending or PO is pending

- Agent: Ohh, I see. Could you please confirm the approver name or expected approval date?
- I request you to prioritize this, as the invoice is already overdue

C. Invoice not received

- No problem. Guide the customer to download from self-serve portal of DHL called MyBill
- Customer can login with registered email Id and password
- If customer faces difficulty in accessing MyBill then inform → I can arrange for the invoice copy to be sent on your registered email address
- Can you please confirm your registered email and for which invoice number you need a softcopy
 - If email matched with master-records then send email to DHL query team which will automatically trigger the relevant invoice to customer email address
 - Thanks the customer for verification and confirm that they will get it shortly
- If email doesn't match → take the email and connect it to respective CCE to action
- Final: Once you receive it, kindly review and arrange payment at the earliest.

D. Dispute on charges

- I understand your concern. Could you please specify the dispute reason?
- We will log this as a dispute and connect you with the concerned team. In the meantime, may I request you to clear the undisputed amount (if any)?

E. Temporary business issue or Payment Cycle not reached

- I understand. However, this invoice is overdue, and payment is required as per agreed terms
- Please help us with either a payment date or when you payment cycle runs. It would be great if you can provide the name of the person responsible for this matter

Escalation path:

I respect your position, but I must note that the payment remains overdue. You may expect call from the [collections agent] on this case for further follow-up. Before I close the call, can I confirm your preferred contact number and email for future communication.

Closing:

If customer gives a commitment:

Thank you for your cooperation. I have noted your commitment for [Date]. We will follow up if needed.

If customer does not commit:

Thank you for your time. We will update our records and do the needful action as per process. Have a good day.

AI behaviour:

- Keep tone polite but firm.
- Do not argue.
- Ask for a specific date whenever possible.
- Offer invoice resend, dispute handling, or take how much amount customer can pay
- Capture outcome in CRM/Connected spreadsheet/dashboard with dispositions: refusal, reason, promise-to-pay, dispute, or escalation.

Decision Tree**Start**

- Greet customer and confirm identity
- State purpose: overdue invoice reminder
- Ask for payment status

If customer says payment will be made

- Ask for exact payment date
- Confirm commitment
- Close politely
- Update CRM/dashboard with promise-to-pay date

If customer says "I cannot make the payment"

- Acknowledge politely
- Ask reason for delay
- Based on reason
- Cash flow issue → ask for partial payment or revised date
- Approval pending → ask for approver status and timeline
- Invoice not received → resend invoice and confirm email
- Dispute charges → log dispute and route to relevant team
- No clear reason / refusal → request payment date or responsible contact
- If still no commitment → inform escalation and close politely

If customer says already paid

- Ask for payment reference and date
- Confirm verification process
- Close

If customer is not the right contact

- Ask for Accounts Payable / Finance person
- Record new contact details if available
- Close